The Cry of Balintawak, 1896

Before the Cry

By 1896 the Katipunan had grown to tens of thousands of members across Luzon, led by its Supremo, Andres Bonifacio. Women joined too: Gregoria de Jesus, Bonifacio's wife, kept the society's papers and seal and was called the Lakambini of the Katipunan. After the society was discovered in August 1896, its leaders knew they could no longer stay secret, and Bonifacio called the members to meet outside Manila.

The Cry of Balintawak (Sigaw ng Balintawak): August 26, 1896

According to this handout, the Cry happened on August 26, 1896, at Balintawak, then part of Caloocan. Bonifacio led the Katipuneros in tearing their cedulas and calling for an armed uprising against Spain. This handout follows the older accounts, including that of Katipunero Guillermo Masangkay, and for many years August 26 was the date taught in schools and marked by a monument in Balintawak.

A date historians still discuss

Eyewitnesses wrote their memories down years later, and they did not all agree on the day or the exact place. Some historians point out that Pugad Lawin and Balintawak were near each other, and that the gatherings lasted several days. Studying the different accounts is part of learning history: always check which source a date comes from.

What happened next

The revolution spread from Manila to nearby provinces, especially Cavite, where Emilio Aguinaldo rose as a leader. Rizal, who was not a member of the Katipunan, was executed in Bagumbayan on December 30, 1896, which pushed even more Filipinos to join the fight.